

HIGH SCHOOLS

Third-seeded Crestwood surprises Walsh Jesuit

By BOB FORTUNA
PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

Crestwood proved sometimes it doesn't matter what seed a team draws last night at the Division II boys district basketball tournament at Solon.

BOYS BASKETBALL

At Solon

All that matters is what team has the most points when the final buzzer sounds.

Crestwood, the third-seed, took its first lead at 4:30 into the first quarter and rolled to a 73-66 semifinal victory over second-seeded Walsh Jesuit.

Crestwood will face first-

seeded Copley (16-5) in Saturday's 7 p.m. final. Copley won, 67-60, over fourth-seeded Kenston (13-10) last night.

"The topic of [Walsh] being the higher-seeded team never was an issue," said Crestwood senior forward Adam Crowder. "We had a lot of respect for Walsh, but we also felt we could run with them."

If anything, the seeding setup fired up the Red Devils, winners of the Portage County League.

"[The seeding] helped us because we knew we were the underdogs coming in," said Crestwood junior guard Brian Moore. "We were in a no-lose situation because of that."

The one aspect that proved Crestwood's Achilles' heel in the first half ended up its ally.

After going 0-for-5 from the foul line in the first 16 minutes, the Red Devils came out in the second half and made 14 of 18, including 10 of 13 in the fourth quarter.

"We shoot 20 free throws at every practice," said Moore, who finished with 16 points. "Coach [Paul Woodard] said we were worrying too much [in the first half]. He told us it was just a game, to go out and have fun."

Crestwood (19-3) had plenty of fun in the first quarter as Walsh (16-7) watched a 10-4 first-

quarter lead turn into a 19-14 advantage for the Red Devils, thanks mainly to a 13-0 scoring run from which the Warriors never recovered.

Two of the Warriors' 10 first-half turnovers resulted in two 3-pointers by Crowder during that span.

Crowder finished with 10 points.

A 7-for-8 performance at the foul line allowed Walsh to cut its deficit to 32-29 by intermission.

"Our 3-point shooting has come along the last half of the season," said Crowder, whose steal and pass to Dave Mayle resulted in an easy layup and extended Crestwood's third-quarter lead to 46-

35.

A basket by Walsh's Pat O'Brien closed the gap at 65-63 with 1:43 remaining, but the Warriors were forced to foul Crestwood and the Red Devils answered by making eight of their last 10 foul shots.

Joe Marek, Crestwood's 6-4 senior forward, had a team-high 20 points and seven rebounds.

Walsh was led by O'Brien and Nick Catanzarite with 21 and 19 points, respectively.

Copley 67, Kenston 60 — The Bombers' made 5 of 18 shots from the field in the first quarter, which reflected Copley's 15-11 lead, and it only got worse.

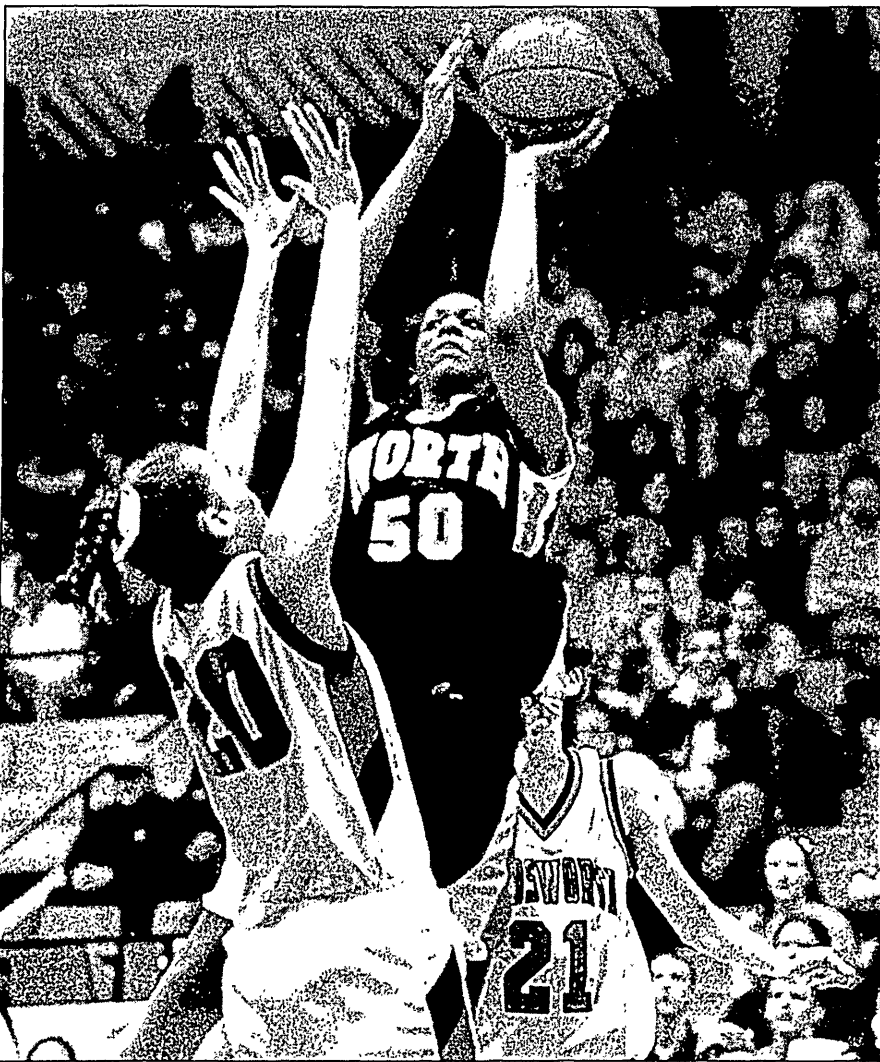
Eight straight points midway through the second quarter upped the Indians' lead to 33-27 at half-time.

Copley junior forward Paul Bosela sank 2 of 6 3-pointers during the run and led all scorers with 22 points.

"There's some added pressure being the No. 1 seed," said Bosela. "Not only do you need to win when you're in that situation, you're expected to win."

Kenston pulled within 64-60 with 34 seconds remaining on Paul Noble's 3-pointer, but the Bombers had no choice but to foul Copley at the foul line.

The Indians closed the game by making 3 of 4 foul shots.



PHIL LONG/ASSOCIATED PRESS PHOTOGRAPHER

Eastlake North's Kaayla Chones shoots against Katelyn Vujas during Wadsworth's 62-60 victory in a Division I regional semifinal game last night in Canton. In background is Elisa Inman.

Wadsworth's strong post play paces win over Eastlake North

POST FROM I-D

"They played a high school basketball game the way it's supposed to be played."

"Wadsworth had us outmanned size-wise, and they have so much talent. It's the kind of team that you like to see go far."

Inman, a 6-2 senior post player, was 9-of-16 from the field. Front-court mate Katelyn Vujas, a 6-2 senior, had 13 points and nine rebounds. The duo helped the Grizzlies to the state championship two years ago.

Inman is still not at full strength after missing much of the regular season with a severely sprained left ankle.

"I try not to think about it," she said. "I'll probably have surgery after the season, but I don't care. This season means so much to me."

Wadsworth led, 39-25, midway through the third quarter. But Chones and guard Erica Zielinski (17 points) led the Rangers in a furious rally, which peaked when Nicole Frantz hit a 3-pointer with 14 seconds left. It cut Wadsworth's lead to 61-60.

Wadsworth point guard Kate Lyren, who made the winning basket in the 1997 state title game, hit a free throw with seven seconds to go. North misfired on a desperation 3-point shot at the buzzer.

"We did everything we wanted to do," Wadsworth coach Todd Osborn said. "We didn't make some late foul shots, but at the other end we made some stops when we had to."

"That was a great win. It was against a team that had beat us by 10 points and handled us pretty well."

North defeated Wadsworth, 74-

64, on Dec. 30, a game which Inman missed with her injury.

Wooster 76, East Tech 60 — Senior forward Quamesha McDowell had 21 points and nine rebounds for East Tech, but the Scarabs couldn't disrupt Wooster's superb execution of its half-court offense. The Generals, ranked third in the state, made 21 of 34 field-goal attempts (62 percent) and 32 of 38 free throws (84 percent). Gordon, a 5-10 senior forward, was 7-of-9 from the field and 15-of-16 at the foul line.

Guard Merlenea Dozier and center Barbara Turner scored 15 and 11 points, respectively, for East Tech (21-2). The Scarabs shot 38 percent and committed 20 turnovers against Wooster's man-to-man defense.

Center Erin Icmann and guard Laci Hicks each scored 11 points for Wooster.

BY THE NUMBERS

BOYS BASKETBALL

YESTERDAY'S SCORES

DIVISION I		
Akron Garfield 69, Hudson 39	at Euclid	
Shaw 87, Mentor 77	at Cleveland South	
Shaker Hts. 74, Bedford 44	at Midview	
Lakewood 35, North Olmsted 31	at Midview	
DIVISION II		
Perly 65, West Geauga 64	at Madison	
Benedictine 80, Harvey 34	at Boardman	
Struthers 40, Youngstown Liberty 38	at Canton Fieldhouse	
Trway 44, Hoban 42	at Canton South 43, Marlington 39	
Crestwood 73, Walsh Jesuit 66	at Solon	
Copley 67, Kenston 60	at Admiral King	
Olmsted Falls 75, Avon Lake 52	at Salem	
DIVISION III		
Louisville Aquinas 73, South Range 62	at Salem	
Other Tournaments		
Cin. Finneytown 59, Clinton-Massie 35	Cin. Madeira 73, E. Clinton 54	
Edgerton 53, Ayersville 51	Fremont St. Joseph 70, Vanlue 67	
Kelley 70, Kentonburg 55	Liberty Benton 58, Wauson 48	
DIVISION IV		
McDonald 54, Sebring 53	Canton Heritage 56, Badger 37	
Carey 60, Tiffin Calvert 55	Fort Jennings 58, Lima Perry 56	
Fort Recovery 68, Wayne-Goshen 34	Lucas 65, Norwalk St. Paul 60	
Minister 50, Knox 43	Peoples 64, Franklin Furnace Green 61	
Regular Season		
School of Arts 38, Martin Luther King 33		

SUMMARIES

DIVISION I

at Copley

Hudson	9	12	7	11-39
Akron Garfield	6	9	14-35	
Hudson: Albright 2, L'Homme 12, Carano 3, Kraus 5, Sorenson 1, Robinson 11, Marincik 4				
Akron Garfield: Kersten 12, Cherry 3, Lewis 15, Vaughn 9, Stark 1, McKee 2, Williams 7				
at Euclid				
Mentor	17	28	15-77	
Shaw	15	17	24-31-87	
Mentor: Bratten 2, Budzjak 12, Radabaugh 27, Andrews 12, Miller 16, Marincik 4				
Shaw: Moore 6, Mosley 2, Davis 24, Robinson 10, Chandler 16, Thornton 10, Padgett 1				
at Cleveland South				
Bedford	6	20	11-7-44	
Shaker Hts.	18	21	17-20-74	
Bedford: Perez 7, Melton 13, Currie 2, Washington 4, Crutcher 11, Apple 6, Johnson 1				
Shaker Hts.: Finley 13, Higgins 6, Tucker 15, Smith 15, Williams 12, Baringer 2, Barnes 5, Dumas 1, Reese 3, Nash 2				
at Midview				
North Olmsted	7	6	8-10-31	
Lakewood	9	7	11-9-35	
North Olmsted: Justin Christafaris 16, Scott Trapp 4, Aaron Kerr 4, James Steele 3, John Thompson 2, Jerry Hazard 2				
Lakewood: Mark Britton 7, Dan Budzjak 7, Rashad Roundtree 6, Scott Patterson 5, Dan Crawford 4, Nadia Eadeh 2, Matt Fannon 2, Jason Beckford 2				
DIVISION II				
at Madison				
West Geauga	14	16	16-19-65	
Perly	12	19	15-18-64	
Perly: Staley 6, Patrick 28, Melec 9, Abrecht 7, Niemczura 14, Jenkins 1				
West Geauga: Morton 14, Force 8, Dolatowski 13, Villagore 8, Novak 10, Sedney 2, Dobnikar 6, Jensen 3				
Benedictine	23	35	14-18-90	
Harvey	8	12	4-10-34	
Benedictine: Woods 16, Leanza 21, Coffey 8, Matthews 4, Crosby 4, Paul 9, Davis 1, Stony 7, Kaiser 7, Cecil 7, Hagler 6				
Harvey: Anderson 4, Fairbanks 2, Shady 4, Michaels 9, Smith 6, Ouzman 2, Rehner 6, Seiki 2, Reynolds 2				
at Boardman				
Youngs, Liberty	9	8	13-38	
Struthers	6	8	13-35	
Youngs, Liberty: White 4, Lev 3, Rivera 4, Robert Austin 14, Ray Austin 9, Davis 4				
Struthers: Sepey 9, McFadden 16, Safarik 4, Becker 8, Harris 2, Donatelli 1				
at Canton Fieldhouse				
Hoban	10	10	10-12-42	
Trway	8	10	10-12-42	
Hoban: A-Higher 11, B. High 4, Matthews 9, Daisler 6, Chaitman 8, Slack 2, Millhouse 2				
Trway: Luster 10, Starr 4, Miller 7, Garrison 12, Tucker 11				
at Solon				
Walsh Jesuit	14	15	16-21-68	
Crestwood	19	13	20-21-73	
Walsh Jesuit: Catanzarite 19, Beige 2, Alabara 8, O'Brien 21, Dawson 12, Rodgers 4, Yoder 4				
Crestwood: Moore 16, Fejedelem 6, Marek 20, Crowder 10, Mayle 17, Danner 2, Kohers 2				

Kenston

11 16 11 22-60

Copley 15 18 22 12-67

Kenston: Hillier 10, Noble 22, Hudson 4, Frazier 8, Motley 9, Barthelme 5, Nowicki 2

Copley: Garman 3, Cottman 21, Jackson 4, Bosela 22, Esbensen 9, Taylor 2, Whalley 4, Norwalk 2

DIVISION IV

at Salem

Olmsted Falls 20 11 25 19-75

Avon Lake 16 11 11 14-62

Olmsted Falls: Mucha 10, Januscak 1, Coch 7, M. Williams 6, Gansey 20, B. Williams 7, Flores 2, Radigan 19, Schneider 3

Avon Lake: Ingelright 14, Kostelnik 10, Guenther 4, Jones 5, May 7, Welch 4, Hamel 2, Skellenger 6

DIVISION III

at Salem

Louisville Aquinas 21 19 16 17-73

South Range 19 17 16 10-62

Louisville Aquinas: Pavlick 19, Blood 2, Weingart 15, Wilsen 10, McClellan 12, Tscholl 11, Evans 4

South Range: Hatch 16, Moore 9, Zigler 2, Fishel 23, Toy 12

DIVISION IV

at Struthers

McDonald 13 16 4 21-54

Sebring 7 14 23 9-33

McDonald: Midick 16, Evans 2, M. Stonestreet 8, E. Stonestreet 11, Rivera 2, Stevenson 15

Sebring: McKinley: Marshall 9, Reichenbach 6, Way 9, Snyder 29

Badger

13 22 9 6-37

Canton Heritage 17 18 13 8-36

Badger: R. Upshire 6, J. Upshire 11, Bell 6, Coleman 9, Harnett 2, Miller 4

Canton Heritage: K. Herschberger 10, Schneider 10, K. A. Johnson 11, Hall 6, Heard 8, S. Herschberger 4

Regular Season

School of Arts 6 8 13 13-38

Martin Luther King 6 4 12 11-33

School of Arts: Tucker 12, Hall 13, Boote 2, Simon 8, Mosley 3

Martin Luther King: Gates 18, Griffin 2, McNair 9, Richmond 2, Walton 2

PAIRINGS

Sectional-District

DIVISION I

at Cuyahoga Falls 36, Stow 31

Yesterday — Akron Garfield 49, Hudson 39

Tomorrow — Cuyahoga Falls vs. Akron Garfield

Today — GlenOak vs. Massillon, 7:30

Yesterday — Youngstown Rayen vs. Wooster, 7:30

at Euclid

Yesterday — Shaw 87, Mentor 77

Today — Euclid vs. GlenOak, 7:30

at Cleveland South

Yesterday — Shaker Hts. 74, Bedford 44

Today — Cleveland Hts. vs. Solon, 6:30

at Cleveland Hts. vs. Solon, 6:30

Yesterday — District Final: Shaker Hts. vs. Cleveland Hts./Solon winner, 1:30

at Lakewood 35, North Olmsted 31

Today — Brunswick vs. Midview, 7:30

Saturday — District Final: Lakewood vs. Brunswick/Midview winner, 7:30

at Baldwin-Wallace

Yesterday — Midpark 59, Brecksville 42

Today — St. Ignace 74, Holy Name 40

Tomorrow — Midpark vs. St. Ignace, 7:30

DIVISION II

at Madison

Yesterday — Perry 65, West Geauga 64

Benedictine 80, Harvey 34

at Boardman

Struthers 40, Youngstown Liberty 38

at Canton Fieldhouse

Trway 44, Hoban 42

at Solon

Walsh Jesuit 14, 15, 16, 21-68

Crestwood 19, 13, 20, 21-73

Walsh Jesuit: Catanzarite 19, Beige 2, Alabara 8, O'Brien 21, Dawson 12, Rodgers 4, Yoder 4

Crestwood: Moore 16, Fejedelem 6, Marek 20, Crowder 10, Mayle 17, Danner 2, Kohers 2

NEWSWATCH

Cheerleaders to compete

Cleveland's Public Schools will hold their annual cheerleading championships Monday at South High. The competition is sponsored by the Student Activities Office.

Collinwood has won the championship seven times since the competition began in 1981. John F. Kennedy won last year, with Collinwood finishing second.

Tickets are \$4 in advance and \$5 at the door for adults.

SOLD OUT — Tomorrow night's Division III district championship boys basketball game between Villa Angela-St. Joseph and Chanel at Lakeland Community College is sold out. No tickets will be available at the door.

FROM STAFF REPORTS

Friday — District final: Newton Falls vs. Ursuline, 7:30

at Salem

Monday — Crestview 64, East Palestine 54

Tuesday — St. Thomas Aquinas vs. South Range, 7:30

Friday — District final: Crestview vs. St. Thomas Aquinas/South Range winner, 7:30

DIVISION IV

at Strongsville

Tuesday — Kldron Central Christian 60, Independence 46; Dalton 74, Richmond Hts. 73 (OT)

Friday — District final: Kldron Central Christian vs. Dalton, 7:30

at Berkshire

Tuesday — Bristol 50, Gilmour 41, Kirtland 64, Mogadore 61

Today — District final: Bristol vs. Kirtland, 7:30

at Struthers

Yesterday — McDonald 54, Sebring 53

Friday — District final, 8

GIRLS BASKETBALL

YESTERDAY'S SCORES

DIVISION I

Holy Name 53, Celina 51

Toledo Central Catholic 80, Magnificat 53

In Canton Civic Center

Wooster 76, East Tech 60

Wadsworth 62, Eastlake North 60

at Columbus Fairgrounds

Pickering 76, Marietta 30

Newark 48, Cincinnati Princeton 44

DIVISION II